

URBAN RECONSTRUCTION TECHNICAL WORKING GROUP (UR-TWG)

Session 4

5th December 2019, HRRP Office, Lalitpur

15:00-17:00

AGENDA

- Finalizing Qualitative Methodology + Wards for study
- Setting work streams for 4 identified issues
- Working Session
- Sharing + Way forward

ATTENDEES

Lumanti, CRS, NSET, and HRRP

KEY POINTS

- **Finalized wards for study**

WARDS ASSIGNED
1) Core heritage:
NSET Bhimeshwar Municipality Dwalkha, Ward number 2
2) Core urban: Lumanti at Siddhipur (1 or 2 FGDs)
3) Peri-urban: NSET at Dhading Nilkantha Ward number 2
4) Ward with many retrofitting beneficiaries: CRS Within Kavre Panauti
5) Dense but not contiguous, RCC dominated: CRS at Okhaldunga/Manthali/Ramechhap/Gorkha
6) Without presence of POs AT ALL: HRRP at Bhaktapur
7) Communities within Guthi
(HRRP to find out/ DRCN anecdotal info from Gorkha)

- **Feedback on Qualitative Methodology incorporated in the Questionnaire matrix.** All members please check the document and if you have some comments/questions, please email Sneha, or directly suggest edits in the Google Sheet [here](#).
- **Timeline:** The members agreed to complete the assigned FGD, KII with municipality and ward officials, and neighbourhood visit components of the study by Christmas/end of December. HRRP to take up a portion of the remaining KIIs and make a schedule + coordinate it.
- Working Session:

Set up work streams for the prioritized issues from Survey Monkey.

Land: CRS, NSET

Finance: Lumanti, CRS, HRRP

STA: NSET, CRS

Policy: Lumanti, HRRP

(More members to be added based on their attendance in the UR-TWG sessions!)

HRRP to support all work streams based on the active participation of HRRP team in UR-TWG meetings, which will be decided internally between HRRP by next week.

- Through the working sessions, the work streams will themselves determine what their agenda and goals are. Below are key points from the meeting working session on finance and STA.

FINANCE

What do we know

- ❖ Urban areas have higher cost of construction compared to rural; heritage housing financing requirement is higher as cost of construction is higher.
- ❖ 25/15 lakh loans @2% interest (given out to 1300 beneficiaries. Has been closed, when?)
- ❖ Presently, there is a provision of a loan of 3 lakhs for reconstruction from NRA with a 5% subsidy, so far only 175 beneficiaries have received it. These are only for those stuck at first tranche. Documents required include: ID, citizenship, Partner Agreement, collateral documents, land papers, letter from ward stating that beneficiary has only received first tranche and proof that hasn't defaulted a previous loan
- ❖ Banks are not giving out these loans in most cases, they do not want to take the risk
- ❖ There is a guideline on the NRA loan, but there is no process document for beneficiaries to know the process
- ❖ Deprived sector loan of 4,00,000 @9-11% interest
- ❖ Informal loans don't require documents but the interest can go as high as 40%
- ❖ Cooperative loans 1-5 lakhs @16%, no collateral. Need to confirm this
- ❖ Microfinance institutions: based on DRCN initial findings, interest rates can be very high, group loans wherein the group is held accountable for defaulters. High pressure retrieval system, has caused stress to beneficiaries.
- ❖ Government top-ups of 50,000NPR are available for NRA's vulnerable category and heritage (facade). There is confusion on this in GMALI and among beneficiaries. Again, there are guidelines but no process document for dissemination
- ❖ Lack of coordination between Rashtra Banks and other banks
- ❖ Discrepancy between PO and government funds. For example if a PO has given the beneficiary 1,00,000NPR, NRA is supposed to give the rest of the reconstruction grant, but it takes a lot of time and follow up
- ❖ Issue of geographical access to tranche amount/loans especially for remote locations (not an urban recovery finance issue)
- ❖ Lack of information sharing for loans, for example need sms services for updates

Who

The identified stakeholders who the workstream will contact for its research/activities
Rashtra Bank

Saksham
Namita Poudel (NRA Banking Coordinator)
Association of cooperatives at district level
DRCN's resources on micro-financing, cooperatives
World Bank
Bankers' association

Scope of work:

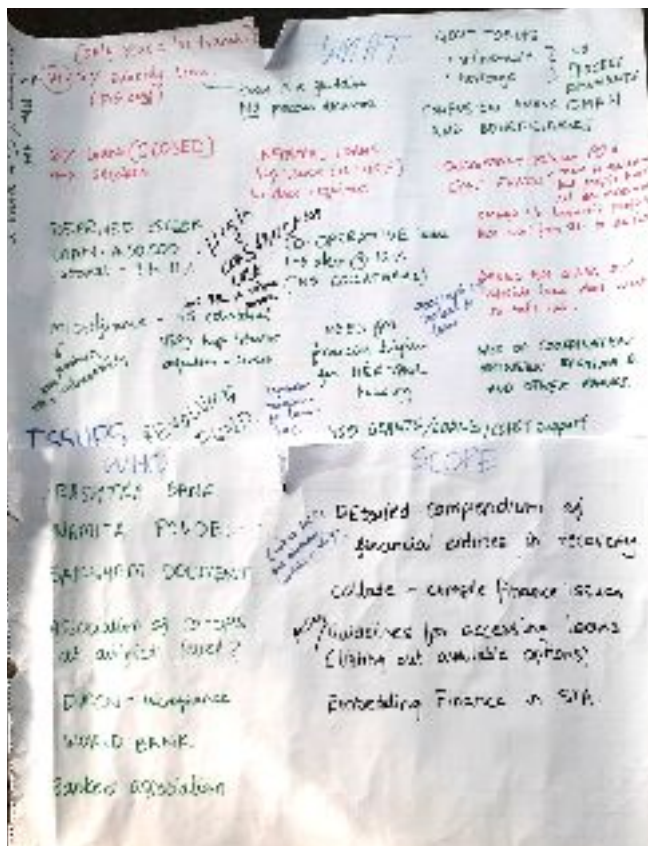
Synthesize and compile finance issues in urban recovery (find out what NGOs are already working on this)

Detailed compendium of financial entities in recovery

Guidelines for beneficiaries to access loans

Embedding finance in STA

Additional reference:



STA

Discussion key points:

- ❖ We have current STA package designed focusing on the rural reconstruction, so not much effective to expedite urban reconstruction, modification of STA, considering urban reconstruction is needed.
- ❖ In urban STA, support through building permit system could be one option to provide technical information to the urban HHs.
- ❖ Mobile mason are effective in reconstruction of the rural houses, but in the case of urban are more trained and effective masons need to be deployed who can help in construction in the site as well.
- ❖ In urban STA, a helpdesk could be more effective than having a mobile mason. Door-to-door is not as favourable in urban as in rural areas
- ❖ Mason training has been provided as per NRA standards. However additional mason-training is required for heritage
- ❖ Mason have been trained based on the NRA/DUDBC curricula, which lack the details on construction technology of traditional buildings/ focused on heritage conservation. Additional refresher training packages need to be designed to enhance the skills of the mason.
- ❖ Community Reconstruction Committees were effective when there was no local government system. At times they have been perceived as competition by local government. As an alternative there could be a task force to support local governments
- ❖ There could be a construction technology *elements* catalog for heritage housing
- ❖ Core focal persons should be appointed to carry out urban STA
- ❖ The speed of demo buildings/model houses has been very slow
- ❖ Demolition needs to be included -- it is an issue of policy, technical and also a social issue
- ❖ How to quantify the various urban challenges based on the number of cases. Require geographic "Mapping of issues"

- **Next Meeting:**

Scheduled: Wednesday, 12th December 3:00pm to 5:00pm

Tentative Agenda:

15 minutes: any updates, remarks on upcoming qualitative study

60 minutes: workstream continues on Finance and STA: come up with objective, outcomes and outputs. Start shaping the outputs

30 minutes: initiate the workstream discussion in groups for policy and land

15 minutes: share key points with the rest of the UR-TWG

~Thank you~

Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform(HRRP)
UR-Technical Working Group Meeting

UR-Technical Working Group Meeting

Venue: HRRP Office, Jwagal, Lalitpur							
S.N.	Name	Gender	Organization	Designation	Phone No.	Email-ID	Signature
1.	Bhuvanendra Panigrahi	F	HRRP	ATC	98510 67 886	tedund.national@hrrpind.org	[Signature]
2.	Kishu Chandra Jolvi	M	HRRP	DTC	9869145919	kishu.jolvi@hrrpind.org	[Signature]
3.	Deepak Sood	M	HRRP	DMT-Task force	9806471656	deepak@hrrpind.org	[Signature]
4.	Laxmi P. Bhatta	M	HRRP	NITCD	9844312565	laxmi@hrrpind.org	[Signature]
5	Ayush Baktara	M	NSET	Program Coordinator	9841943131	abaktara@nset.org	[Signature]
6.	Meeta Shrestha	F	HRRP	PMT-IT	9844246349	meeta@hrrpind.org	[Signature]
7.	Basundhara Mahajan	F	Lumant	U-Planner	9841530979	basundhara02@gmail.com	[Signature]
8.	Bhakt. Shrestha	M	CCS	STC	9841731408	bhakti.shrestha@ccs.org	[Signature]
9.	Adeel Javid	M	CCS	RC	9860483783	adeel.javid@ccs.org	[Signature]
10	Sneha Malani	F	HRRP	Volunteer	9810370037	snehamalani@gmail.com	[Signature]